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Rules of Procedure

The term "Rules of Procedure" collectively refers to the set of guidelines that govern the conduct of debate, committee sessions, and the decision-making processes within a Model United Nations conference.

Quorum

For any session to be declared open, Quorum is required. Quorum refers to ⅓ of the House Representatives being present.

Where one third of the registered delegations is not a whole number, the required quorum is rounded up to the next whole delegation. Chairs should verify quorum again if attendance changes before a vote.

In order to move to the voting procedure, Quorum is required. For a decision to be adopted, the votes in favour must exceed the votes against (not including abstentions).

Student Officers are strongly encouraged to keep track of their Roll-Call sheet, and mark absent delegates appropriately.

Roll Call

A sheet with the registered delegations within each committee will be provided to the Student Officers prior to the conference ("Roll Call Sheet"). Student Officers are responsible for taking absences at the beginning of each day, and prior to the commencement of each session. Student Officers are required to inform the Student Affairs Division of any absent delegates.

If a delegate is unable to attend a session or needs to leave before the end of a session, they are required to inform their Chairs, who in turn must inform the Student Affairs Division.

At the end of each roll call, Student Officers should ask if a delegation has not been called out, to ensure that all present delegates have been marked as such.

Modes of Debate

Open Debate is the main form of debate used in MoMUN, when debating on resolutions. During Open Debate, any delegation may obtain the floor to deliver a speech (either in favour, or against) the current item.

When debating on amendments, the committee moves to **Closed Debate**. During Closed Debate, separate time is allocated for Speeches in Favour and Speeches Against the current item.

Points

Points may not interrupt a speaker. They can only be raised when the floor has been yielded to the Chairs, or when a Delegate has finished with their Speech (e.g. Point of Information) The only exception is the Point of Personal Privilege. Before stating their point, delegates must await recognition from the chairs.

Point of Information [to the Speaker]

The Point of Information to the Speaker refers to a question raised by a delegate. It is directed to the delegate that currently has the floor, if they have indicated that they are open to accepting Points of Information from the House.

After a delegate's speech, Chairs must ask if the delegate "is open to any Points of Information". The delegate can respond in any of the following ways:

1. Not open to Points of Information
   In this case, the Chairs ask the Speaker to yield the floor (see "Yielding the floor")

2. Open to any [and all] Points of Information, or
3. Open to up to N Points of Information
   In these cases, the Chairs ask any delegates that may wish to state a Point of Information to raise their Placard. Chairs may recognise as many delegates as they wish, so long as time allows, and they do not exceed the POI limit set by the Speaker.

Delegates that have been recognised may state their POI in the order they have been called at. Each delegate rises and makes their Point. They then remain standing until they have received a response by the Speaker. After the Speaker has finished replying, the delegate sits, the next one rises, and the process continues until all Points have been answered.

The Point of Information must be articulated in the form of a clear question directed at the Speaker. It may be preceded by a small statement, exclusively intended to provide necessary context for the question stated.

If the Speaker could not understand or hear the question, they may ask the Chairs to request a repetition or clarification of the Point ("Could the delegate please repeat/rephrase/… their Point?"). **No direct dialogue between delegates is allowed.**

A Speaker retains the right to reply to a Point of Information "via a note".

Immediately after receiving a response to their Point, a delegate may request recognition for a "Follow-up" POI (see "Motion to follow-up"). It falls within the Chairs' discretion whether they recognize the delegate a second time, depending on time constraints, and on whether a follow-up would contribute to a meaningful debate. Before entertaining a follow-up POI, the Chairs must ask the Speaker if they are willing to accept it. The follow-up has to be relevant to the original point stated by the delegate.

While follow-ups are not encouraged, each delegate may request up to one follow-up question per Point of Information, subject to the Chairs' recognition and the Speaker's agreement.

Point of Information to the Chairs

The Point of Information directed to the Chairs refers to a question directed to the chairs, whose contents do not fall under the Point of Order or Point of Parliamentary Inquiry. For example, questions about current affairs or the committee agenda require a Point of Information to the Chairs to be raised.

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

A Point of Parliamentary Inquiry is raised to state a question regarding the Rules of Procedure.

The Point of Parliamentary Inquiry is non-debatable and may not interrupt a speaker.

Point of Order

A delegate may raise a Point of Order if they believe that a Chair has made a mistake in the order of debate, debate time, or another matter relating to the procedure. The delegate may ask whether an action taken by a Chair is "in order". The Chair must respond by explaining whether their action is justified. If the Chair has indeed made a mistake, they must "**stand corrected**".

The Point of Order is non-debatable and may not interrupt a speaker. It needs to be a **direct referral** (relating to something that just happened); otherwise, the point is out of order.

Point of Personal Privilege

A Point of Personal privilege is related to a delegate's well-being or personal requests (e.g. heating, technology issues, etc.)

The Point of Personal Privilege may not interrupt a speaker, unless it refers to the delegate's ability to hear the speaker (audibility).

Upon raising a Point of Personal Privilege, not relating to audibility issues, the Chairs should ask the delegate if they would like to approach, to discuss the issue on a personal level -not in front of the entire committee.

Motions

Motions can only be raised when the floor is open and may not interrupt a speaker for any reason.

Motion to approach the chairs

When a delegate wishes to speak with the Chairs on a personal level, they may raise this motion.

Motion to move to the previous question

The Motion to move to the previous question is used to close debate on an item, and to immediately proceed with the voting procedure on this item. If the motion is raised during closed debate, and more specifically during the time in favour, then the motion calls to immediately proceed with time against.

When the motion is raised, the Chairs must ask the House if "there are any seconds". Delegates that wish to second the motion need to raise their placards. Subsequently, the Chairs ask if "there are any objections".

If a delegate objects to the motion, or there are no delegates seconding, it is automatically overruled. This motion is non-debatable, not voted upon and it may not interrupt a speaker. Chairs may overrule the motion at their own discretion.

Motion to extend debate time

The Motion to extend debate time can be raised by a delegate wishing to increase allotted debate time on an item. It can only be raised towards the end of discussions on an item.

A motion to extend debate time may only extend the specific segment of debate currently in progress. For example, during Closed Debate on an amendment, a motion raised during time against may only extend time against, as time in favor has already elapsed.

This motion requires a second. It falls within the Chairs' discretion, whether the motion will be entertained.

Motion to follow-up

A delegate may raise this motion immediately after receiving a response to a question they stated to the Speaker (see Point of Information), in order to request recognition for a follow-up POI. It falls within the Chairs' discretion, whether the motion will be entertained.

Motion to extend Points of Information

A delegate may raise this motion at the end of allocated time for Points of Information to a Speaker, in order to ask for a second round of POIs. The motion must be raised before the Speaker has yielded the floor.

The motion may only be considered if the Speaker has opened themselves to "any and all" Points of Information. If the Speaker has instead specified a limited number of Points, the motion may only be entertained if that limit has not yet been reached, and only for the remaining number of Points available.

In all cases, the Chairs must first ask the Speaker whether they are willing to accept additional Points of Information. The decision to entertain the motion ultimately remains at the discretion of the Chairs.

Motion to divide the House

The motion to divide the house can be raised immediately after the votes on an item have been counted (during the voting procedure). The House will be asked to vote again, with abstentions not being allowed.

It falls within the Chairs' discretion to decide whether the motion to divide the house is entertained. For example, if the number of abstentions would not suffice to change the result of the vote, the Chairs may overrule the motion.

Motion to retake the vote

A delegate may raise this motion if they believe that a mistake has been made during the counting of the votes, or if they have voted twice. It falls within the Chairs' discretion, whether the motion will be entertained.

A Chair may also proceed with retaking the vote without motioning, if they believe that not all delegates have voted, or for another reason that would render the voting procedure invalid.

Motion to vote by roll call

This motion can be raised if the Chairs (or delegates) believe that not all present delegates have cast their vote on a matter. If the motion is entertained, the House proceeds with a roll call vote; the Chairs call the name of each present delegation, which must state its vote.

As the roll call vote is a very time-consuming procedure, Chairs are encouraged to avoid it, unless necessary for purposes of clarity.

Motion to adjourn debate

This motion may be raised in order to temporarily suspend committee proceedings and have a break. It falls within the Chair's discretion, whether the motion will be entertained.

Motion to withdraw a resolution

This motion can be raised by anyone within a committee to request that a resolution is withdrawn from consideration. It can only be raised with regard to the resolution that is being debated on at that time.

For the Motion to be in order, all co-submitters need to be in favor of the resolution's withdrawal. If a Resolution is withdrawn, the Responsible Secretariat Member of the committee needs to be informed. The Co-Submitters of the resolution need to discuss whether the resolution will be modified and reintroduced for debate. However, committee proceedings must not be interrupted, meaning that any changes must be done during a break.

The Chairs of a Committee may motion for the withdrawal of a resolution without the co-submitters' agreement. However, this can only be done under extreme circumstances (plagiarism, use of AI, etc.)

Right of Reply

The Right of Reply can be raised by a delegate, who believes their personal or national integrity has been impugned by the remarks of another delegate. The delegate raising the point can be recognized, at the Chairs' discretion, and deliver a short statement or speech, in order to support their position.

The Speech delivered under the Right of Reply is not open to Points of Information. The Right of Reply may not interrupt another speaker.

Yielding the floor

After finishing a speech, the Chairs should ask the delegate if they are open to Points of Information. Delegates may respond affirmatively or negatively, to which the Chairs should act accordingly.

After all POIs have been answered, the Chairs ask the delegate "how they wish to yield". The delegate may respond in one of the following ways:

1. "We yield the floor to the chairs"

In this case, the debate continues. The Chairs may call on another speaker, move to the voting procedure, make announcements, etc.

2. "We yield the floor to the delegate of X"

   A delegate may yield the floor to another delegate, if they wish.

   Chairs may or may not entertain the yield, depending on remaining time, participation of the delegate that is being yielded to, and other factors. Before entertaining the yield, the Chairs should ask the delegate that is being yielded the floor whether they accept and wish to proceed with a speech.

   During closed debate, a yield between delegations may only be made **if time remains** in, either the "time in favour" or the "time against". This means that the last speaker during "time in favour" or "time against" may only yield to the Chairs.

   Yields between delegates can only be made **once**, consecutively. The delegate that has been yielded the floor to may only yield the floor to the Chairs.

Amending a Resolution

Amendments are a way in which delegates can modify a resolution during debate, and can also enhance debate.

For a delegate to submit an amendment, they have to fill in their delegation name, the clause that the amendment refers to, whether it wishes to modify or strike out a clause, or add a new one, and the proposed modification and send it to the chairs in a method that has been agreed upon by the committee. After they submit it to the Chairs, they can decide whether to entertain it or not.

When receiving an amendment, Chairs should check the following:

1. Whether the amendment is related to one or more clauses.
   An amendment must only refer to one clause. In order to modify multiple clauses, separate amendments need to be submitted.
2. Whether the amendment is properly formatted.
3. Whether the amendment would contribute to a meaningful and constructive debate.
4. Whether the amendment is aligned with the committee mandate and UN Charter.
5. Whether remaining time on this resolution allows the introduction of and debate on an amendment.

For any of the above reasons, chairs may decide that an amendment should/should not be introduced, or that one amendment should be prioritized over another.

If a Chair decides that an amendment should be introduced, they announce it to the committee, and display the amendment for everyone to see. Subsequently, they move to **Closed Debate** and set debate time.

Debate time on an amendment is set by number of speeches. For example, debate time on an amendment can be set to "Two speeches in favor, and two speeches against". The number of speeches in favor must be equal to the number of speeches against.

The first speech on an amendment -after moving to closed debate- should be the speech of the submitter of the amendment, which counts as a speech in favor. Chairs may also ask the submitter of the amendment to read it aloud prior to delivering their speech.

Please note that closed debate time is counted as part of the overall debate time allocated to the resolution. Therefore, any time spent debating amendments during closed debate is deducted from the total remaining debate time on the resolution as a whole.

At the end of time against, the Chairs put the amendment to a vote. If it passes, its wording is incorporated into the resolution displayed to the committee; if it fails, the resolution remains unchanged. The committee then returns to Open Debate on the resolution, using the remaining debate time.

Second-degree amendments

A Second-degree amendment ("Amendment on an amendment") may only be introduced during the time allocated against the first-degree amendment.

Time allocated for the debate of a second-degree amendment does not count as time against the amendment.

Discussions on the first-degree amendment are to continue regardless of whether the second-degree amendment passed or not.

If a second-degree amendment passes, its changes are incorporated into the first-degree amendment before debate on that amendment resumes. The first-degree amendment must still be voted upon. If the second-degree amendment fails, debate resumes on the original wording of the first-degree amendment.

We recommend that Chairs avoid introducing second-degree amendments, as they can be confusing and time-consuming, while not contributing significantly to the debate.

Amendments to the third degree or further are not in order.

Friendly amendments

A Friendly amendment is an amendment that is not changing the substance of a clause, but instead corrects grammatical, syntactical or formatting errors. Friendly amendments may pass without a vote.

Friendly amendments are not formally in order in MoMUN. However, if a Chair identifies an error as such within a resolution that does not affect the substance of the clause, they may propose it and pass it automatically, provided that no co-submitter of the resolution objects.

Voting on an item

The voting procedure is the final part of discussions on any item (resolution or amendment). All Member States of the UN retain the right to vote, with the exception of the two Permanent Observers (Holy See and Palestine). Delegates may vote in favor, or against an item, while delegates not wishing to cast a vote may abstain.

When deciding on a procedural matter (motions) delegates may not abstain from voting.

Before the voting procedure on an item begins, Chairs should ask Administrative Staff to escort all guests outside the committee, while Security Staff should "seal the doors" to ensure that no one exits or enters the room. Furthermore, before the voting procedure begins, Chairs should ensure that all present delegates are in the committee room.

During the voting procedure no Points or Motions are in order, with the exception of the Point of Personal Privilege. Motions pertaining to the voting procedure (Motion to divide the House, to retake the vote, etc.) may only be raised after votes have been counted.

An item passes if the votes in favor exceed the votes against. If the votes in favor are equal in count to the votes against, the item does not pass. If the House does not raise an appropriate motion, such as a Motion to Divide the House, the Chairs may propose that a delegate within the committee does so.

Chairs should count and record votes in favour, votes against and abstentions separately, check that the total corresponds to the eligible delegations present, and announce both the totals and the result. After any motion concerning the vote has been resolved, the doors may be reopened and note passing may resume.

Lobbying

The Lobbying procedure takes place at the beginning of the conference proceedings within a committee. Delegates form alliances and create a joint document ("Resolution") proposing solutions to the agenda topics of their assigned committee. It consists primarily of informal discussions between delegates.

Delegates should be able to form alliances on their own, in accordance with the foreign policy of the Nation they represent. However, if the Chairs deem it necessary, they may assist delegates in identifying an appropriate alliance. Additionally, if Chairs notice that a delegate is within an alliance that does not align with their Nation's policy or interests, they should intervene and reposition the delegate accordingly.

The co-signatory Nations of a resolution must designate a delegation as the Main Submitter, who is responsible for presenting the resolution in front of the committee during its introduction, and delivers the opening speech during debate.

Each delegate within a committee can only co-submit one Resolution per agenda topic. Chairs should check that each delegate has co-submitted at least one resolution per topic and no more than that, and that the co-submitting nations' policies are aligned.

Following the conclusion of the lobbying procedure on a resolution, Chairs should make appropriate corrections and then submit them to the Approval Panel. You will find detailed instructions on how to correct a resolution in the respective section of this Manual.

Plagiarism or the use of Large Language Models of Artificial Intelligence (LLMs) during the drafting or correcting of a resolution are strictly prohibited.

During the Lobbying procedure, the Chairs of a committee should assist the delegates by making corrections and comments "on-the-fly", in order to guide them to create a better resolution. The "Expert Chair" (author of the respective Study Guide) should also be present during the Lobbying procedure on their topic, to answer questions regarding the issue and its resolution.

Note Passing

During moderated caucus (formal debate) delegates are allowed to exchange written notes. The content of the notes should be in English and be relevant to the debate. Chairs and administrative staff may read the content of the notes.

If Chairs feel that note passing is disruptive towards the committee and creates commotion, they may suspend it and reinstate it at any time.

Cross-committee note passing is not permitted. Note passing is also suspended during the voting procedure.

Funding

Clauses that include funding sources may be included in resolutions and discussed during debate. However, no resolution can include specifications of exact financial amounts. Including possible funding methods and financial resources is in order.

Final Remarks

Student Officers should apply the Rules of Procedure consistently, remain impartial, and give delegates a fair opportunity to participate. Before each session, Chairs should agree on their division of responsibilities, prepare all relevant documents, and check that the committee can view resolutions and amendments.

Where this Manual does not address a procedural question, Chairs should consult their Responsible Secretariat Member before announcing a ruling. Any clarification should be communicated clearly to the committee and applied consistently. Attendance concerns should be referred to the Student Affairs Division as indicated above.

Resolution Formatting and Correction

Structure of a Resolution

A resolution consists of 3 parts:

1. Header
2. Preambulatory Clauses
3. Operative Clauses

Header

The Header contains the Committee Name, Resolution Topic, and the names of the co-signatory Nations that authored the resolution.

FORUM: Disarmament and International Security Committee (GA1)

QUESTION OF: Addressing the implications of drone warfare for asymmetric conflict in the Red Sea

SUBMITTED BY: Canada

CO-SUBMITTED BY: Australia, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Netherlands, Norway, Republic of Korea, United Kingdom, United States of America

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (GA1),

1. The labels ("Committee", "Topic" etc.) should be in **bold**.
2. The Committee name should be written in full, and the respective abbreviation should be put in (brackets).
3. The Name of the Main Submitter of the resolution is not included again in the "Co-submitted by" field.
4. The co-submitting Nations should be ordered alphabetically, and country names should be written in full (e.g. "Democratic People's Republic of Korea", not "DPRK").

Preambulatory Clauses

The preambulatory clauses are the opening clauses of the resolution. They contain reasoning, background, context, and justification for the actions proposed in the Operative Clauses section.

Deeply concerned by the increasing proliferation of unmanned aerial vehicles in regions affected by asymmetric conflict,

Recalling Article 2 of the Charter of the United Nations regarding the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Member States,

Recognising the strategic importance of the Red Sea for international trade and maritime security,

1. The preambulatory phrases should be *italicized*.
2. Each preambulatory clause ends in a comma.
3. Preambulatory clauses are not numbered.

Operative Clauses

Operative Clauses are the most important part of the resolution. They propose actions, decisions, requests, solutions, or recommendations to the issue at hand.

1. Calls upon Member States operating in the Red Sea region to strengthen naval coordination mechanisms aimed at monitoring and intercepting hostile unmanned aerial systems;

2. Requests the United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research (UNIDIR) to further examine the implications of asymmetric drone warfare through:
    a) the publication of annual analytical reports,
    b) consultations with Member States and relevant experts, and
    c) recommendations regarding emerging technological threats;

3. Encourages regional and international cooperation aimed at reducing the destabilising effects of drone warfare in asymmetric conflicts through:
    a) the establishment of joint maritime surveillance initiatives in the Red Sea region,
    b) the sharing of technical expertise relating to counter-drone systems and aerial threat assessment,
    c) the development of coordinated response mechanisms for attacks targeting civilian or commercial vessels, including:
        i. emergency communication channels between affected states,
        ii. rapid-response naval coordination procedures, and
        iii. joint simulation and preparedness exercises,
    d) support for capacity-building programmes assisting developing coastal states in improving maritime security infrastructure.

1. The operative phrases should be underlined.
2. Each operative clause ends with a semi-colon, except for the final operative clause, which ends with a full stop.
3. Operative clauses are numbered as follows:
    a. Clauses start with **1.** (Arabic numeral + period)
    b. Sub-clauses start with **a)** (lowercase Latin letter + closed bracket)
    c. Sub-sub-clauses start with i. (lowercase Roman numeral + period)
4. Each sub- and sub-sub-clause ends with a comma, while the clause itself ends with a semi-colon.
5. There is a line space between each clause.
6. There is only one full stop at the end of the entire resolution.

General Formatting Instructions

Font: Times New Roman
Size: 11

Justification: Justify (full)
Line Spacing: Single (1.0)
Paragraph spacing
Before: 0pt
After: 8pt

Page Margins: Moderate
Top: 1”
Bottom: 1”
Left: 0.75”
Right: 0.75”

Resolution Correction Checklist

Check that the committee, agenda topic, Main Submitter and co-submitters are correctly identified, with no duplicate delegation entries.

Check that proposed actions address the topic and fall within the committee’s mandate. Identify unclear wording, contradictory clauses and proposals that do not specify who should act or how they would be implemented.

Check clause numbering, introductory phrases, punctuation, indentation, spelling and the formatting requirements listed above. Ensure that references to existing documents and organisations are accurate.

Discuss substantive issues with the submitters so that corrections preserve their intended proposals. Resolve outstanding questions with the Responsible Secretariat Member and forward the corrected resolution to the Approval Panel before introducing it for debate.

Appendices

Appendix A: Preambulatory Phrases

The following phrases may be used to introduce preambulatory clauses. Select a phrase that accurately reflects the context; italicise the introductory phrase and end the clause with a comma.

Acknowledging; Affirming; Alarmed by; Aware of; Bearing in mind; Believing; Concerned about; Considering; Deeply concerned; Deeply regretting; Emphasising; Expressing appreciation; Expressing concern; Fully aware; Guided by; Having considered; Noting; Noting with appreciation; Observing; Reaffirming; Recalling; Recognising; Taking into account; Taking note of; Welcoming

Appendix B: Operative Phrases

The following phrases may be used to introduce operative clauses. Underline the introductory phrase and select wording appropriate to the committee's mandate. In order to repeat a phrase, delegates may precede it with the word "Further".

Acknowledges; Affirms; Calls for; Calls upon; Encourages; Endorses; Expresses appreciation; Expresses concern; Invites; Reaffirms; Recommends; Requests; Supports; Takes note of; Urges

Stronger formulations such as "Decides", "Demands" or "Authorises" should be used only where appropriate to the powers and role of the committee being simulated.

Appendix C: Example Resolution

The example below illustrates the header, clause hierarchy and punctuation described in this Manual. It is a formatting example for training purposes.

FORUM: Disarmament and International Security Committee (GA1)

QUESTION OF: Addressing the implications of drone warfare for asymmetric conflict in the Red Sea

SUBMITTED BY: Canada

CO-SUBMITTED BY: Australia, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Netherlands, Norway, Republic of Korea, United Kingdom, United States of America

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (GA1),

Deeply concerned by the increasing proliferation of unmanned aerial vehicles in regions affected by asymmetric conflict,

Recalling Article 2 of the Charter of the United Nations regarding the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Member States,

Recognising the strategic importance of the Red Sea for international trade and maritime security,

1. Calls upon Member States operating in the Red Sea region to strengthen naval coordination mechanisms aimed at monitoring and intercepting hostile unmanned aerial systems;
2. Requests the United Nations Institute for Disarmament Research (UNIDIR) to further examine the implications of asymmetric drone warfare through:
    a) the publication of annual analytical reports,
    b) consultations with Member States and relevant experts, and
    c) recommendations regarding emerging technological threats;
3. Encourages regional and international cooperation aimed at reducing the destabilising effects of drone warfare in asymmetric conflicts through:
    a) the establishment of joint maritime surveillance initiatives in the Red Sea region,
    b) the sharing of technical expertise relating to counter-drone systems and aerial threat assessment,
    c) the development of coordinated response mechanisms for attacks targeting civilian or commercial vessels, including:
        i. emergency communication channels between affected states,
        ii. rapid-response naval coordination procedures, and
        iii. joint simulation and preparedness exercises,
    d) support for capacity-building programmes assisting developing coastal states in improving maritime security infrastructure.